

any “online friends” made through social networking sites. If they do, make sure that they discuss with you and go ahead with your permission. If such a thing should happen, choose a public place for meeting the “cyber friend” especially in the presence of an adult.

A lot of language on the internet is bad and if your child gets a particularly obscenely worded message, advise them to not revert. This also applies to those messages which are creepy or just plain weird.

Another rule on the internet, especially for the youngsters, is to never send out their photographs to any of their cyber-friends. Most often, such requests usually harbour ill intentions and can compromise the safety of your child.

Ensure that your children know that they must never enter an area where they are charged for services without being asked.

Interact with other parents and keep in touch with the latest threat on the internet. In our world of instant information, ignorance is sadly, not bliss.

Also ensure that the internet access to children, at home or school, is closely monitored by a responsible adult.

The ABC of internet use

Always be careful each time you are on the internet. Never write down your passwords. Memorize them. This rule also applies to other sensitive information – like social security number or credit card information.

First step – keep your computer updated. Switch off auto updates as most cybercriminals use such flaws in computer systems to attack your machine while safely remaining anonymous. The simple act of not opting for auto updates can cut down a large number of automated attacks on your system.

Ensure that your computer comes with a secure configuration. This simply means having to walk that thin line between too much or no security. If there is too much security, there are chances that the user gets frustrated. On the other hand, no security means increased vulnerability to cybercrimes. Most computers can easily be configured to provide maximum security.

Choose passwords that are strong and protect it. Your username, passwords and personal identification numbers (PIN) are quintessential for each and every online transaction. A strong password should be an alphanumeric melange and should never have the obvious details, like your name or telephone number in it. Using the same passwords for many sites increases